



1ST WEEK: **DAY 4**

First outing

YOUR BABY TODAY

The pediatrician will examine your baby today. They will ask if your baby is alert and check for any signs of [jaundice](#). They will also weigh your baby and will ask how they are getting along with feeding and whether there are any problems.

“Your body is gradually recovering from the birth, and you may be starting to feel like facing the world once again.”

Until now, your breasts have produced colostrum, the watery premilk rich in nutrients and antibodies. Once your milk is in (around day 3 or 4), your baby will start to feel more satisfied and your breasts will likely feel engorged and uncomfortable. As feeding establishes over the next few days, this discomfort should start to recede. Your uterus will be steadily reducing in size but can still be felt by pressing on your abdomen. Your blood loss will have started to ease off by now, although you may find that it's heavier first thing in the morning and also while you're breastfeeding.

You'll visit the pediatrician today for the baby's first in-office checkup. They will look for any signs of dehydration, such as your baby not having plenty of wet diapers and any feeding problems. They'll also measure your baby's weight, length, and head circumference. The measurements will be plotted on a graph to track your baby's own growth curves at all of their subsequent appointments. The doctor will also examine the soft spots (fontanelles) on your baby's head; look into their ears, eyes, and mouth; listen to their heart and lungs; and examine their abdomen, hips, legs, and genitals.

TAKING YOUR BABY OUT

Make sure you have everything you may need before venturing out on a trip.

- **Pack a diaper bag with** two diapers, wipes or cotton pads, a spare onesie, a cloth, and a bottle of formula if you're bottle-feeding.
- **Take layers of clothing** on outings, including an undershirt, onesie, and cardigan. In winter, add an all-in-one babysuit and a blanket in a stroller.
- **A third of a baby's heat is lost through their head**, so on cool days, add a hat or hooded top. Socks and booties are easy to lose. Footed onesies are more practical; mittens are needed only in cold weather.
- **In hot weather, make sure your baby is covered** and protected from direct sunlight at all times.